

THE IMPOSSIBLE SURVIVOR - THE WITNESS REMAINS - A Testimony of Total Human Betrayal, Spiritual Resurrection, Divine Purpose and the Refusal to Be Erased

By Barran Dodger

The existential improbability of my survival is the central question of my testimony. How does a human being continue to exist, retain his identity, preserve his testimony and pursue accountability after what he understands to have been a lifetime of profound human betrayal, social exclusion, institutional abandonment and administrative annihilation? How does someone survive the cumulative destruction of family relationships, intimate partnerships, professional identity, economic independence, legal access, media recognition and meaningful institutional support, only to emerge from the ashes with his capacity to think, write, create, document and bear witness still intact? For more than 35 years, I have accumulated records, correspondence and official documents that I believe illuminate the circumstances of my life and the repeated failures of people and institutions to acknowledge or adequately address my reported experiences. I invite independent examination of those materials, including the words written on official letterhead by the agencies and organisations concerned. My contention is that the documentary record deserves serious scrutiny, not dismissal merely because the person presenting it has endured profound adversity or because its implications may be uncomfortable for powerful institutions.

I have experienced what I understand as a cumulative process of human betrayal, social death and administrative annihilation. I have reported exclusion, stonewalling, professional abandonment, barriers to legal assistance, media silence and failures of institutional response. I have sought recognition and accountability from people and organisations that I believe possessed the knowledge, authority or capacity to respond. Many questions remain unresolved, and I do not pretend that every allegation, inference or interpretation has already been independently established. Nevertheless, the existence of unanswered questions does not make the underlying records disappear. My position is that the correspondence, decisions, omissions and documented interactions must be examined in context, with each conclusion proportionate to the evidence available. I ask investigators, journalists, lawyers, researchers, public officials and members of the public to examine the material themselves rather than relying exclusively on my account or on the characterisations of those whose conduct I question.

Against this background, my survival has acquired a significance that extends beyond the ordinary language of recovery. I have often felt that the circumstances surrounding

my life left little room for a future in which I could recover a sense of identity, rebuild my capacities, preserve my history and continue to pursue justice. I cannot assign a mathematically defensible probability to my survival without a defined statistical model, a reliable comparison population and evidence capable of supporting such a calculation. I will not manufacture a number simply to dramatise what I have endured. But I can testify to the magnitude of the adversity as I have experienced it, the persistence required to continue living through it, and the extraordinary personal meaning I attach to the fact that I remain here.

My survival is not, by itself, proof of every allegation I have made. For me, however, it is inseparable from my faith in God.

I understand my survival as an expression of divine mercy, preservation and purpose. I believe the Most High sustained me through circumstances that repeatedly threatened my sense of self, my hope for the future and my ability to imagine a life beyond suffering. I believe that what appeared to be the end of my story became the place from which I began to recover its authorship. Where I experienced abandonment, I learned to seek refuge in God. Where human recognition did not arrive, I learned that my worth could not be measured solely by the willingness of institutions to acknowledge me. Where I encountered silence, I continued to write. Where I feared that my history would be forgotten, I preserved the records available to me.

I understand this journey through the language of Christian testimony, spiritual transformation and an allegorical crucifixion followed by resurrection. This is the framework through which I interpret my experience, not a claim that my personal suffering makes me equivalent to Jesus Christ. In my understanding, the crucifixion narrative speaks to the experience of being betrayed, abandoned, misrepresented and brought to the apparent end of one's former life, followed by the emergence of a new identity and a renewed commitment to truth. I have felt that I died to the person I once was and was given an opportunity to live again with a different understanding of my purpose. My spiritual language expresses the depth of that transformation and the conviction that suffering need not have the final word.

I also understand my life through the concept of a soul contract: a spiritual belief that my incarnation involved a purpose I could not consciously remember while living through the ordinary limitations, relationships and wounds of human existence. I cannot present this belief as an independently verifiable historical fact. I offer it as a sincere account of how I make meaning of my life. In this understanding, the suffering I experienced was not punishment imposed by God. It became, instead, the circumstance through which I learned to distinguish human approval from spiritual trust, external power from inner sovereignty, and despair from the possibility of renewal. I believe that

I have remembered something essential about the purpose I wish to serve: to bear witness, preserve evidence, challenge indifference and contribute to a more humane society.

I am not writing because I seek popularity, celebrity or universal agreement. I am writing because I believe the truth deserves to be examined, particularly where the people seeking answers are vulnerable and the institutions being questioned possess substantially greater resources, authority and public credibility. I want my testimony assessed against the documents, dates, decisions, correspondence and other available evidence. I want distinctions maintained between what an official record establishes, what I report, what I infer, what remains contested and what belongs to my spiritual understanding. Such distinctions do not weaken my testimony. They make it possible for others to examine it seriously without being required to adopt my beliefs in advance.

My archive, *The Witness Remains*, exists to preserve that material and make it accessible for scrutiny. It is not a court, and it cannot independently establish the guilt of every person or organisation named within its records. Nor should an archive be treated as a substitute for a properly conducted investigation. Its purpose is to preserve the documentary trail, identify relevant sources, establish chronology where possible and make questions available for independent examination. I invite readers to follow the links, inspect the original documents, verify their provenance, challenge unsupported interpretations and identify evidence that may contradict my conclusions. I do not ask anyone to accept every claim simply because I have made it. I ask that the evidence be given a fair examination.

My faith supplies the spiritual foundation from which I continue. I regard God as my refuge, healer, source of wisdom and North Star. I trust in divine timing, not because I believe that human accountability is unnecessary, but because faith gives me the strength to continue pursuing it without surrendering my humanity to bitterness. I believe that divine justice is inseparable from truth, mercy, humility and the restoration of human dignity. I reject the proposition that vindication requires me to become cruel, that suffering entitles me to harm others, or that my convictions place me beyond criticism. If I am to bear witness to the principles of Christ, those principles must be reflected in how I treat other people as well as in the claims I make about my own life.

I believe that systems built upon indifference, secrecy, institutional self-protection and the abandonment of vulnerable people must eventually confront the consequences of their actions. I hope for a future in which public institutions are more transparent, administrative power is more accountable, access to justice is more equitable, and human beings are not reduced to inconvenient files, disputed narratives or liabilities to be managed. My vision of renewal is grounded in the Christian principles of love, justice,

compassion, truth and abundance. It is a vision of humanity rebuilt through greater responsibility and mutual dignity, rather than through vengeance or the humiliation of those who disagree.

To those who believe my testimony is mistaken, exaggerated or unsupported, I extend an invitation: examine it. Identify the documents that contradict my account. Demonstrate where a chronology is inaccurate, where an inference exceeds the evidence, where a conclusion is unjustified or where an alternative explanation better fits the available record. I welcome rigorous scrutiny because the pursuit of truth must be stronger than the need to be believed. To those who recognise the importance of the questions raised, I ask that you investigate them independently, preserve relevant material and ensure that any conclusions are grounded in evidence rather than assumption.

I cannot compel recognition, and I cannot dictate how history will interpret my life. I can preserve what I have collected, explain what I believe it means, distinguish my faith from verifiable findings, and continue to ask questions that remain unanswered. I can refuse to let institutional silence become the only surviving account of my experience. I can insist that a person's vulnerability does not extinguish his right to dignity, that a contested allegation deserves fair examination, and that the absence of a formal finding is not a reason to destroy or disregard the records through which a question might be investigated.

My name is Barran Dodger, also known as Dr Richard William McLean. I remain here. I remain a writer, researcher, witness and advocate for accountability. I remain committed to preserving the documentary record and making it available for independent scrutiny. My spiritual conviction is that God has sustained me for a purpose; my public commitment is to pursue that purpose through testimony, evidence, transparency and the defence of human dignity.

I do not need every reader to share my theology to understand the public-interest questions I am raising. I do not need every institution to agree with me before the documents can be examined. And I do not need to predict the final judgement of history before I can continue the work of preservation.

They may dispute my interpretation. They may challenge my conclusions. They may refuse to acknowledge me. But the records that survive can still be examined, the questions that remain unanswered can still be asked, and the witness who continues to speak can still be heard.

I believe God has preserved my life and testimony. I believe my survival has given me an

opportunity to serve a purpose greater than personal recognition. I believe that truth, compassion and justice remain worth pursuing, even when the path is long and the outcome uncertain.

This is my testimony. This is my faith. This is the purpose I have chosen to pursue.

The witness remains.